

UNIT 7 / Home and neighbourhood

Read a housing advert

Your goal: Find basic facts in a short apartment advertisement.

01 Learn the idea

Housing adverts often compress information: 2 Zimmer, Küche, Bad; 60 m²; 800 Euro. Zimmer normally counts living rooms and bedrooms, while Küche and Bad are listed separately. Look for size, price and location instead of trying to translate every abbreviation on first reading.

Die Miete means rent and die Nebenkosten means additional charges. Warmmiete and Kaltmiete describe different rent totals, so ask what is included rather than assuming. For simple enquiries, use Ist die Wohnung noch frei? and Wie hoch ist die Miete? The practice advert here is fictional.

Words and phrases

German	English
die Miete	the rent
zwei Zimmer	two rooms
sechzig Quadratmeter	sixty square metres
Ist die Wohnung noch frei?	Is the apartment still available?
die Nebenkosten	the additional charges

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Ist die Wohnung noch frei?

Is the apartment still available?

Owner

Ja. Sie hat zwei Zimmer und ist sechzig Quadratmeter groß.

Yes. It has two rooms and is sixty square metres.

Ben

Wie hoch ist die Miete?

How much is the rent?

Owner

Achthundert Euro plus Nebenkosten.

Eight hundred euros plus additional charges.

Your real-life mission

Create a fictional advert with room count, size and rent. Write two questions you would ask before arranging a viewing.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “die Miete” mean?

- A. the rent
- B. two rooms
- C. sixty square metres

2. What does “zwei Zimmer” mean?

- A. sixty square metres
- B. two rooms
- C. Is the apartment still available?

3. What does “sechzig Quadratmeter” mean?

- A. Is the apartment still available?
- B. the additional charges
- C. sixty square metres

4. What does plus Nebenkosten tell you?

- A. All charges are included
- B. Additional charges are extra
- C. The apartment is free

5. How many rooms does the apartment have?

- A. Two
- B. Three
- C. Six

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. A - the rent

“die Miete” means “the rent”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. B - two rooms

“zwei Zimmer” means “two rooms”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. C - sixty square metres

“sechzig Quadratmeter” means “sixty square metres”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - Additional charges are extra

Plus means the stated rent does not include those additional charges.

5. A - Two

The owner says zwei Zimmer.

One possible mission response

2 Zimmer, 60 m², 800 Euro plus Nebenkosten. Ist die Wohnung noch frei? Wie hoch sind die Nebenkosten?

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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